

SeekerScore.com — Product Audit

Full user-journey audit | April 16, 2026 | Diagnosing 'generic' and 'limited customization' perceptions

Core Diagnosis

Seeker is a career intelligence tool trapped in the body of a resume scanner. It has real differentiation — multi-source live job matching, three-axis scoring (skill/domain/seniority), search transparency — but wraps it in the visual language, interaction model, and marketing vocabulary of the exact category it claims to transcend.

The product's sophistication is entirely server-side and invisible. The user experience is: upload file, wait, read static report. This is indistinguishable from Jobscan or Resume Worded at a behavioral level, even though the output is richer.

The fix is not backend work. It's making the intelligence visible.

Phase 1: First Impression (0-10 Seconds)

5-second read: 'It scores my resume.' The headline ('You're applying to jobs you're not getting — Find out why') and CTA ('Analyze your resume, free') place this squarely in the resume-scanner category alongside Jobscan, Resume Worded, and Teal.

What causes instant categorization as 'generic':

- Dark theme + purple accents — the 2024-2026 default SaaS/AI aesthetic
- Score numbers (64/100, 91%, 76%) — identical to every resume scanner
- 'Analyze your resume' CTA — functionally identical to competitors
- '0+ resumes analyzed' counter — actively undermines credibility
- Product Hunt / TinyLaunch badges — signals early-stage side project

Verdict: Not differentiated on first impression.

Phase 2: Value Prop vs. Perceived Product

What the product actually does (buried in How It Works page):

- Matches resume against thousands of live openings from 5+ job APIs (Adzuna, USAJobs, Remotive, Jobicy, Jooble)
- Scores fit across three axes: skill alignment, domain fit, seniority calibration
- Shows per-role ATS readiness scores
- Provides search transparency (how many openings evaluated, search strategy used)
- Includes career trajectory analysis

What the homepage communicates:

'Upload resume, get score, see matches.' One subheadline mentions live matching. Everything else uses scanner vocabulary. The three-axis model, multi-source aggregation, search transparency, and career trajectory are invisible on the homepage.

The product is significantly more advanced than it appears. The homepage reduces it to 'score + matches' — the exact frame of every competitor.

Phase 3: Layer-by-Layer Journey

Layer A: Pre-Auth Marketing Surface

Pages: Homepage, How It Works, Compare, Pricing, Demo

What feels generic: Hero headline pattern, purple/dark theme, score metrics display, FAQ section, upload funnel structure.

What feels differentiated: The Compare page (specific, concrete competitor breakdowns with feature matrix). The phrase 'Not a score — a plan.' The privacy commitment. The per-role match cards showing specific gap analysis.

Problem: The Compare page is the best differentiation messaging on the site, but it's behind a nav link most users never click.

BUG: Homepage has a massive rendering void — multiple viewport-heights of black space between hero and FAQ sections. Content exists in DOM but renders as dead space.

Layer B: Auth / Account Creation

Sign-up offers Google, GitHub, or email/password. Clean and simple. Says 'Save your results, track your resume history, and unlock Pro features' but shows no preview of what the dashboard looks like.

BUG: /signin returns 404. Correct path is /sign-in (with hyphen). No redirect exists. The nav 'Sign In' link works but manual URL guessing breaks.

NOTE: GitHub auth is unusual for a career tool. Signals 'developer audience' — potentially confusing for general job seekers.

Layer C: Upload Flow

The best-designed page on the site. Shows auto-detected location with 'Change' option, remote roles toggle, file upload area, and a right-sidebar preview of results format.

User inputs before analysis: 2 total. Location (auto-detected city) and remote toggle. No target role, industry, seniority, salary, or skill preferences.

BUG: Upload fails silently for files near 5MB limit. Error shows only 'Upload failed' — no file size hint, no status code, no guidance. Root cause: Vercel 4.5MB body limit vs client 5MB limit.

Layer D: Results (Assessed via Demo)

The demo shows: market position percentile, roles matched count, resume readiness %, position/strength/gap narrative summary, strength tags, top match cards with per-role gaps and ATS readiness, and priority skill gaps ranked by frequency.

The results content is the most differentiated part of the product.

But the results are static and non-interactive:

- No filters to sort/filter by location, score, domain, or company
- No drill-down into match cards

- No 'show more like this' or 'exclude this type'
- No 'what-if' scenarios (e.g., 'what if I added Kubernetes?')
- Insights tab (career trajectory, search transparency) is non-functional in demo
- 'Showing 5 of 8' with 3 locked behind Pro paywall

Phase 4: Customization Audit

Stage	User Controls	Missing
Upload	Location, Remote toggle	Target role, industry, seniority, salary, company prefs
Analysis	Nothing	Any parameter at all
Results	Nothing	Score filter, domain filter, sort, drill-down
Follow-up	Apply links	Save roles, compare versions, what-if scenarios

Total user-controllable surface: one location field and one toggle. The system's intelligent inferences (seniority detection, domain weighting, search expansion) are real customization mechanisms — but they happen invisibly. The user never sees 'We detected you as Senior-level' or 'We expanded to remote roles due to limited local supply.'

Phase 5: Why It Feels 'Generic'

Dimension	Finding
Visual design	Dark + purple = default 2024-26 SaaS aesthetic. Indistinguishable from dozens of AI tools.
Category cues	Score numbers, upload funnel, 'analyze your resume,' 'skill gaps' — all scanner signifiers.
Copywriting	Standard problem-agitate-solve. Differentiator stated once in a missable subheadline.
CTA language	'Analyze your resume, free' — identical to every scanner CTA.
Flow structure	Upload > wait > static results. Same interaction model as every competitor.
Post-result	Read-only report. No filters, no iteration, no reason to return.
Output style	Better report than competitors — but still a static report, not an interactive tool.

Three types of 'generic':

- **Looks like others** — dark theme, purple accents, score numbers, upload funnel. Confirmed.
- **Behaves like others** — upload > wait > static results. Partially confirmed. Results are richer, but the interaction model is identical.
- **Differentiation hidden too late** — multi-source matching, three-axis scoring, career trajectory, search transparency are all invisible until post-analysis or buried in How It Works. Confirmed.

Phase 6: Where Differentiation Lands

Unique Feature	First Visible	Too Late?
Live multi-source matching	Homepage subheadline (1 line)	Easy to miss
Three-axis scoring	How It Works page only	Yes
Per-role ATS readiness	Results page only	Yes
Search transparency	How It Works description	Yes
Market position ranking	Homepage sample + results	Partially
Privacy architecture	Upload page + FAQ	No — well placed

The product stops feeling generic at the results page — but only if you read carefully. By then, the user has already formed their category judgment based on 3+ pages of scanner-coded marketing. The differentiation never achieves escape velocity from the category it's trapped in.

Phase 7: Testable Hypotheses

H1: Homepage hero uses scanner vocabulary [\[Pre-auth\]](#)

Evidence: 'Analyze your resume' CTA, score numbers, 'skill gaps' — standard scanner terms. Differentiator in small gray subtext.

Test: A/B test: lead with 'See which jobs you'd actually get' instead of 'Find out why.'

H2: Upload page offers only 2 inputs [\[Upload\]](#)

Evidence: Only location + remote toggle. No target role, industry, seniority, or salary input.

Test: Add 1-2 optional fields (target role, industry). Measure perceived customization.

H3: Three-axis score collapsed into single number [\[Results\]](#)

Evidence: Results show '89% match' — never broken into skill/domain/seniority components.

Test: Show mini-breakdown on each card: Skills 92% / Domain 85% / Level 90%.

H4: Results are read-only, no interactive controls [\[Results\]](#)

Evidence: No filters, no sort, no drill-down, no what-if.

Test: Add minimum-score slider + domain filter. Measure engagement time.

H5: Insights tab broken in demo [\[Demo\]](#)

Evidence: Clicking Insights doesn't switch view. Trajectory/transparency features hidden.

Test: Make Insights functional in demo. Measure differentiation perception.

H6: System inferences are invisible [\[Upload+Results\]](#)

Evidence: Auto-detects seniority, domain, expands searches — but never tells the user.

Test: Show 'What we detected' confirmation before analysis starts.

H7: Demo behind secondary CTA most users skip [\[Homepage\]](#)

Evidence: 'Preview analysis first' is a ghost button next to primary CTA.

Test: Embed truncated demo results directly on homepage.

H8: '0+ resumes analyzed' undermines credibility [\[Homepage\]](#)

Evidence: Counter shows zero. Signals untested beta.

Test: Remove until 500+, or replace with testimonial.

H9: No what-if or iterative capability [\[Results\]](#)

Evidence: One report, no refinement. Can't test 'what if I added Kubernetes?'

Test: Add 'See impact' teasers on skill gaps (even locked for Pro).

H10: Privacy messaging crowds out product depth [\[All pages\]](#)

Evidence: 'Resume deleted' appears everywhere. Unique features get no homepage space.

Test: Reduce to one trust badge. Use space for three-axis model or trajectory preview.

H11: Compare page is great but nobody visits it [\[Pre-auth\]](#)

Evidence: Best differentiation copy on site, behind a nav link.

Test: Pull strongest comparison line onto homepage above fold.

H12: Free tier caps create dead end [\[Results\]](#)

Evidence: 5 of 8 matches shown, 3 locked. No iteration without paying.

Test: Show all matches free; gate deep features (tailored resume, interview prep).

Phase 8: Severity Ranking

#1: Most likely cause of 'generic' — Homepage uses scanner vocabulary

Score numbers, 'analyze your resume' CTA, dark/purple theme place product in scanner category within 5 seconds. Differentiation is buried. Sets mental model that colors entire experience.

#2: Most likely cause of 'limited customization' — 2 inputs + static results

Upload has only location + remote toggle. Results are read-only with no filters, sort, or iteration. This is the most concrete, defensible criticism a reviewer can make. It's true.

#3: Pre-auth: Demo is hidden and partially broken

Demo is behind secondary CTA most skip. Insights tab non-functional. Career trajectory and search transparency — the most differentiating features — remain invisible before signup.

#4: Post-auth: Three-axis score collapsed into single number

User sees '89% match' but never sees skill/domain/seniority breakdown. Makes the score indistinguishable from Jobscan's keyword-overlap percentage.

#5: Results: No interactive controls

No filters, sort, drill-down, or what-if. Results are a static document that ends the session rather than beginning an ongoing tool relationship.

Phase 9: High-Leverage Fixes (No Backend Rebuild)

Homepage

1. Reframe hero CTA from 'Analyze your resume, free' to 'See where you'd get hired' — shifts mental model from scanner to market intelligence
2. Replace sample score display with a single match card showing the three-axis breakdown (Skill/Domain/Seniority) — previews the unique output format
3. Pull Compare page's best line onto homepage: 'Resume scanners check formatting. Seeker tells you that adding Kubernetes would match you with 4 more Senior DevOps roles at \$180K+ companies.'
4. Remove '0+ resumes analyzed' counter until it shows a credible number
5. Fix the rendering void between hero and FAQ sections

Auth / Onboarding

1. Add redirect from /signin to /sign-in
2. Show dashboard preview on sign-up page
3. Consider removing GitHub auth unless targeting developers specifically

Upload Flow

1. Add optional 'Target role' and 'Target industry' fields — dramatically increases perceived customization

2. Show detected resume attributes before analysis: 'We detected: Senior-level, Sales/Engineering domain.' Let user confirm or correct.
3. Fix upload error: replace 'Upload failed' with specific messages and drop client limit to 4MB

Results Page

1. **Highest leverage change:** Show three-axis score breakdown on each match card (Skills 92% / Domain 85% / Level 90%) — instantly differentiates from single-number scanners
2. Add basic filter controls: minimum score slider, domain filter, remote-only toggle
3. Make Insights tab functional in demo — career trajectory and search transparency are the most differentiated outputs
4. Show search transparency: 'Evaluated 4,200 openings across 5 sources. Expanded to remote roles due to limited local supply.'
5. Add what-if teasers on skill gaps: 'See how adding this skill changes your matches' (even locked for Pro)

Bugs Found During Audit

BUG: Homepage rendering void: Multiple viewport-heights of black space between hero and FAQ. Likely CSS animation or lazy-loading issue.

BUG: /signin 404: No redirect from /signin to /sign-in. Nav link works but manual URL fails.

BUG: Upload failure: Files near 5MB fail silently. Error shows only 'Upload failed' with no context. Vercel 4.5MB body limit vs client 5MB limit.

BUG: '0+ resumes analyzed': Social proof counter reads zero. Undermines credibility.

BUG: Demo Insights tab: Clicking does not switch view. Career trajectory features invisible pre-auth.

Audit conducted April 16, 2026 via live browsing session. All findings from actual product interaction.